



Situation Report of the 17th Ebola Virus Disease Outbreak / DRC

SitRep N°129/MVE-BDBV/20/09/2026

Report date: 20 September 2026

Publication date: September 21, 2026



HIGHLIGHTS (last 24 hours)

A total of 61 new confirmed cases of Ebola Virus Disease (EVD), including 22 community deaths, have been reported in the provinces of Ituri (34 cases), North Kivu (23 cases), and Haut-Uélé (4 cases). In addition, 11 deaths within Ebola Treatment Centers (ETCs) have been recorded.

No new health zones have been affected in the last 24 hours.

ACCUMULATIVE	ACCUMULATIVE	LETHALITY	PATIENTS IN	ACCUMULATIVE	TRACKING RATES
CAS	DEATH		ISOLATION/CTE	HEALED	CONTACTS
7 733	CONFIRMED 3 732	48,3%	821	1 902	(Of the Day) 81,4%



Affected Provinces and Affected Health Zones



7 Provinces affected

Uele, Ituri, North Kivu,
South Kivu, Tshopo, Lower Uele and
Sud Ubangi

63 out of 167
health zones affected

(37,7%)

Summary of key points from the last 24 hours

During the course of the day on September 20, 2026, **61 new confirmed cases**

Cases of Ebola Virus Disease (EVD) have been reported, including **22 community deaths**. The confirmed cases are spread across the provinces of **Ituri**. (34 cases), **North Kivu** (23 cases) and **Haut-Uélé** (4 cases).

However, **11 intra-CTE deaths** (8 in Ituri, 2 in North Kivu and 1 in Haut Uélé) were recorded, bringing the total number of confirmed deaths for the day to **33**.

In the last 24 hours, **23 patients** have been declared recovered (**10 in Ituri, 10 in North Kivu and 3 in Haut Uélé**) after obtaining two negative results for Ebola virus disease.

Since the start of the epidemic in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC), a cumulative total of **7,733 confirmed cases, including 3,732 deaths**, has been recorded, representing a case fatality rate of **48.3 %**. The epicenter remains the Ituri province, which accounts for **76.9% of the cases** of the reported confirmed cases and also represents (**55.7 %**) of the new confirmed cases.

No new health zones have been affected in the last 24 hours.

hours. Thus, **63 out of 167 health zones (37.7%)** have been affected in **7 provinces** since the start of the epidemic. Ituri has 28 out of 36 affected health zones, followed by North Kivu (16/34), Haut-Uélé (7/13), Tshopo (7/23), South Kivu (1/34), Bas-Uélé (3/11) and South Ubangi (1/16).

Furthermore, **55 health zones spread across 5 provinces (not including South Ubangi: imported confirmed cases)** remained active while **8 health zones** have not reported any confirmed cases for **42 days** or more.

Table 1. Distribution of confirmed cases and deaths by affected province, as of September 20, 2026.

Province	New confirmed cases (24h)	Confirmed cases	Deaths (confirmed)	Lethality	Affected health zones
Ituri	34	5947	2 722	45,8%	28/36 (77,8 %)
North Kivu	23	1425	862	60,5%	16/34 (47,1 %)
Haut-Uélé	4	311	128	41,2%	7/13 (53,8 %)
Boss	0	39	14	35,9%	7/23 (30,4 %)
South Kivu	0	3	1	33,3%	1/34 (2,9 %)
Bas-Uélé	0	7	4	57,1%	3/11 (27,3%)
Sud Ubangi	0	1	1	100,0%	1/16 (6,3%)
Total	61	7 733	3 732	48,3%	63/167 (37,7 %)

Table 2. Distribution of confirmed cases and deaths by province and zone as of September 20, 2026

Province / Health Zone	Cumulative number			Current situation (24 hours)			
	Cas (n)	Deaths (n)	Lethality	New Case	Community deaths (Swab+)	Confirmed deaths within the CTE	Total confirmed deaths
Ituri	5947	2722	45,8%	34	11	8	19
Give	11	1	9,1%				0
Undersand	8	6	75,0%				0
Ariwara	8	2	25,0%				0
Aungba	12	5	41,7%				0
Bamboo	196	40	20,4%	3	0	1	1
have	2	2	100,0%				0
Bunia	1662	520	31,3%	8	3		3
Ladies	40	9	22,5%				0
Drodro	15	7	46,7%				0
Fireworks	81	30	37,0%				0
Gethy	7	3	42,9%				0
Flounder	2	0	0,0%				0
Kilo	34	12	35,3%				0
Team	147	90	61,2%	0	0	1	1
Liter	275	138	50,2%	2	2	1	3
Logo	13	5	38,5%				0
Fight	31	8	25,8%				0
distributed	4	1	25,0%				0
Washing	21	9	42,9%				0
Darkness	59	33	55,9%				0
Mangala	337	146	43,3%	4	0	0	0
Mongbwalu	689	321	46,6%	3	0	2	2
Nanny	269	145	53,9%	3	3	1	4
Nizi	756	276	36,5%	2	0	2	2
Legumes	127	36	28,3%	1	0		0
Jungle	12	4	33,3%				0

Rwampara	1054	355	33,7%	8	3		3
Tchomia	75	25	33,3%				0
A valves*	THAT	493	THAT				0
North Kivu	1425	862	60,5%	23	10	2	12
Me	281	197	70,1%	6	4	2	6
Farm	18	7	38,9%				0
Butembo	252	161	63,9%				0
Ten	1	0	0,0%				0
Kalunguta	47	15	31,9%	4	0		0
Cut	544	344	63,2%	2	1		1
Source	1	0	0,0%				0
Kyondo	32	20	62,5%				0
Lubero	20	10	50,0%	4	3		3
Be careful.	24	11	45,8%				0
Manguredjipa	11	4	36,4%	1	1		1
Masereka	25	9	36,0%	1	0		0
The museums	121	65	53,7%				0
Mutwanga	9	2	22,2%	1	0		0
Oicha	14	11	78,6%	1	1		1
Vuh	25	6	24,0%	3	0		0
Haut-Uélé	311	128	41,2%	4	1	1	2
Kili Mangbetu	36	15	41,7%				0
Dumb	1	1	100,0%				0
Gombari	3	1	33,3%				0
Mathematics	99	43	43,4%	1	0	1	1
Lining	68	32	47,1%				0
Beans	2	1	50,0%				0
Ordinary	102	35	34,3%	3	1	0	1
Boss	39	14	35,9%	0	0	0	0
Bafwasende	7	1	14,3%				0
Kabondo	5	1	20,0%				0
Lubunga	1	0	0,0%				0
Maquis-Kisangani	20	9	45,0%				0
Mangobo	4	2	50,0%				0
Boss	1	0	0,0%				0
Wanie-Rukula	1	1	100,0%				0
South Kivu	3	1	33,3%	0	0	0	0
Miti-Murhesa	3	1	33,3%				0
Bas Uélé	7	4	57,1%	0	0	0	0
Blind	1	1	100,0%				0
Viadana	3	1	33,3%				0
Walk	3	2	66,7%				0
Sud Ubangi	1	1	100,0%	0	0	0	0
Hair	1	1	100,0%				0
Total	7733	3732	48,3%	61	22	11	33

*These are the confirmed deaths that occurred in the various CTEs in the province which are being broken down to be classified by health zone.

NA : Not Applicable.

Table 3. Status of alerts notified by province for September 20, 2026

DPS	Alerts Received		Total alerts	Alerts verified and validated (suspected case)		Alerts verified and invalidated (no suspected cases)		Number of suspects investigated	Number of suspects investigated and transferred to CTE/CT (of the day)
	Living	Deceased		Living	Deceased	Living	Deceased		
Haut-Uélé	ND	ND	THAT	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Bas-Uélé	65	3	68	4	2	61	1	6	0
Ituri	751	77	828	110	77	631	0	182	82
North Kivu	775	46	821	72	46	695	0	118	45
Sud Ubangi	ND	ND	THAT	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND	ND
Boss	47	0	47	7	0	40	0	7	0
Total General	1 638	126	1 764	193	125	1 427	1	313	127

Figure 1. Evolution of cases by date of symptom onset over the last 21 days

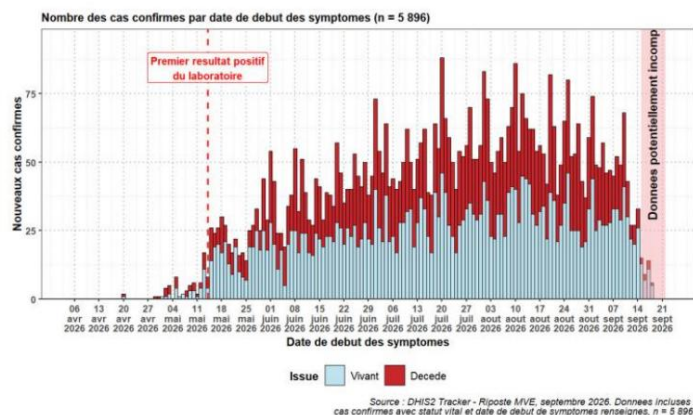
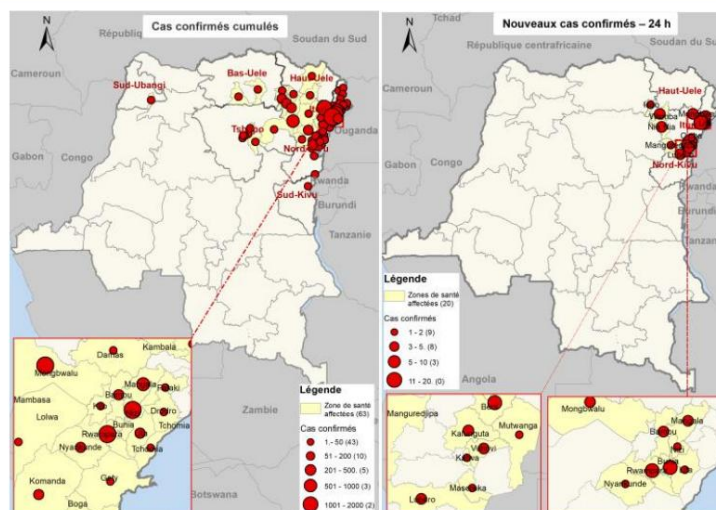


Figure 2. Spatial distribution of confirmed cases (24h and cumulative) by health zone.



1. COORDINATION

1.1. Main Actions

- Launch of vaccination of frontline providers in Bunia (Ituri province).

2. RESPONSE ACTIONS BY PILLAR

2.1. Epidemiological surveillance

2.1.1. Main Actions

By the end of the day on September 20, **1,764 alerts** had been reported; **1,746 (99.0%)** were verified. Thus, 318 alerts were validated as suspected cases, of which 313 (98.4%) were investigated, and 127 were transferred to CT/CTE (Table 3).

Over the past 24 hours, **27,281 contacts** were seen out of **33,520** currently being monitored, representing a follow-up rate of **81.4 %**, higher than the previous day's rate (79.9%). This rate was 100.0% (42/42) in South Ubangi, 91.5% (193/211) in Bas-Uélé, 83.9% (271/323) in Tshopo, 83.3% (11,057/13,280) in North Kivu, and 79.9% (15,718/19,664) in Ituri.

2.2. Update on checkpoint and point of entry (PoE/PoC) activities

2.2.1. Main actions

Three (3) live alerts were notified to the PoE/PoC in the last 24 hours, two (2) in Ituri, at the PoCs of Dele (Rwampara Health Zone) and Foner Mambasa (Mambasa Health Zone), and one (1) in North Kivu, at the PoC of Mukulia (Beni Health Zone). All three alerts were validated and investigated within 24 hours (100%; 3/3), and two were transferred to the CT/CTE (66.7%; 2/3), with the suspect in Foner Mambasa refusing transfer.

Table 4. Status of key indicators for PoE/PoC by province, as of September 20, 2026

Indicators	Ituri	North Kivu	Boss	Haut-Uélé	Global
Report completeness	93,3% (56/60) 100%	(20/20) 100%	(18/18) 85,7% (6/7) 95,2%	(100/105)	
% of functional strategic PoE/PoC	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Number of people who have switched to PoE/PoC	134 552	88 283	21 495	12 776	257 106
% of travelers screened	96,6%	98,1%	99,3%	99,2%	97,5%
% of travelers who washed their hands	96,6%	98,1%	99,4%	99,0%	97,5%
% of travelers made aware	99,3%	98,1%	100,0%	100,0%	99,0%
Number of alerts notified	2	1	0	0	3
Number of validated live alerts (cas suspects)	2	1	0	0	3
Number of bodies intercepted today % of suspected	0	0	0	0	0
cases transferred to CTE/CT	50,0% (1/2)	100% (1/1)	THAT	THAT	66,7% (2/3)
% of lifeless bodies swabbed/secured	THAT	THAT	THAT	THAT	THAT
% of suspected cases investigated within 24 h	100% (2/2)	100% (1/1)	THAT	THAT	100% (3/3)

2.2.2. Challenges

Low alert encoding in DHIS2 Tracker and insufficient mobility in Rwampara and Bunia; persistent insecurity hindering the commissioning of the Avakubi PoC (Ituri); In North Kivu, lack of support from security agents to the PoCs on the Butembo axis and threats against service providers.

2.3. Laboratory

2.3.1. Main actions

- **Ituri: 34 new positive results** (23 living and 11 deaths) out of 116 new samples received and analyzed (**positivity: 29.3%**).
- **North Kivu: 23 new positive results** (13 living and 10 dead) out of 229 samples analyzed (**positivity of 10.0%**).
- **Haut-Uélé: 4 new positive results** (3 living and 1 death) out of 13 samples received and analyzed at the Isiro laboratory (**positivity: 30.8%**).
- **Tshopo: 7 samples received and tested (live)**, all came back negative.
- **Bas-Uélé: 30 samples received and analyzed at the Isiro laboratory**, all returned negatives.

2.4. Infection Prevention and Control (IPC/EDS)

2.4.1. Main actions

- **In Ituri**, 13 out of 41 septic tanks (31.7%) were opened, and 52 out of 54 identified households (96.3%) were decontaminated; 3 out of 3 health facilities (FOSA) were decontaminated, and no households received hygiene kits. Regarding the blood and sanitation services (EDS), 78 alerts were recorded (including 6 postponements from the previous day), 61 EDS were carried out (78.2%), and 52 bodies were swabbed; 13 bodies could not be swabbed.
- **In North Kivu**, 17 out of 26 infection control rings were opened (65.4%), 12 out of 28 households were decontaminated (42.9%), and 17 out of 22 health facilities were decontaminated (77.3%). Nine infection prevention and control (IPC) scorecard assessments were conducted in nine health establishments (HEs) with an average score of 27%, and the staff exposure risk assessment classified 6 out of 28 staff members as high risk. Regarding the health monitoring system (HMS), 50 alerts were received (plus 19 reports from the previous day), 50 bodies were swabbed, and 47 HMS tests were carried out.
- **In Tshopo**, the training of 50 PPLs (Personal Protective Equipment) in the Makiso-Kisangani Health Zone concluded; decontamination of 4 households with incineration of belongings and of the La Borne nursery school; 13 ESS (Emergency Social Services) were monitored and supported, with 139 service providers briefed on standard precautions. Regarding EDS (Emergency Response Scheme), no alerts were received and 1 EDS was carried out (postponed from the previous day's assessment at the CTE - Technical Center).
- **In Bas-Uélé**, 4 service providers and 3 hygienists were briefed in 3 ESS in the Ganga health zone, the functionality of the 3 pre-triages in the Buta health zone was monitored and the PCI and PECH inputs were packaged for the Ganga health zone.

2.4.2. Challenges

In North Kivu : the health zones of Biena, Masereka, Kyondo, Mabalako, and Vuhovi remain uncovered by decontamination activities due to a lack of training and motivation among the dedicated teams. **In Tshopo**, there is a shortage of infection prevention and control (IPC) supplies in social and health establishments (SHEs), households, schools, and markets; IPC kit coverage is only partial in SHEs (37.6%; 35/93); and the incinerator at the Makiso-Kisangani General Referral Hospital (HGR) remains out of service.

2.5. Holistic care

2.5.1. Main actions

- **In Ituri**, 77 new admissions were recorded during the day, compared to 73 discharges, including 10 recoveries. Thus, 442 patients are hospitalized out of 1015 beds (occupancy rate of 43.5%); 393 out of 422 patients (93.1%) received hot meals, and children under LNPE/SLM were fully covered at the CTE (13/13), at the nursery (3/3), and in the community (27/27).
- **In North Kivu**, 63 new admissions were recorded against 123 discharges, including 10 recoveries; 316 patients are hospitalized, including 208 in standardized facilities with a capacity of 228 beds, representing an overall occupancy rate of 91.2%.
- **In Haut-Uélé**, one new admission was recorded compared to 10 discharges (3 recovered). Thus, 45 patients are hospitalized out of 138 beds, representing an occupancy rate of 32.6%.
- **In Tshopo**, one new admission was recorded with no discharges. Twelve (12) patients are in isolation out of 31 beds, representing an occupancy rate of 38.7%; 7 confirmed cases and 1 suspected case received a hot meal, as did 20 suspected cases and 42/42 (100%) frontline workers.
- **In Bas-Uélé**, one new admission was recorded with no discharges. Thus, 6 patients are hospitalized in ESS.

2.5.2. Challenges

Care still partially substandard and limited capacity: **In Ituri**, the CTE/CT facilities are saturated with suspected cases: Nizi, Mambasa, Lolwa, Kilo, Mangala, and Mandima. **In North Kivu**, 34.2% of hospitalized patients are treated outside of standardized facilities; no beds are available.

It is not available in Butembo and Katwa. In **Tshopo**, the lack of safe blood and limited technical resources persist. In **Bas-Uélé**, the absence of TSE/CT centers and ambulances limits the isolation of cases.

2.6. Vaccination

2.6.1. Main actions

- In **Ituri**, 30 PPL (17 men and 13 women) were vaccinated in the Bunia health zone, with no reported AEFI; research activities on the effectiveness of ERVEBO against BDBV Ebola virus disease are continuing.
- In **Bas-Uélé**, 874 PPLs have been vaccinated to date, including 550 in Buta, 211 in Ganga, 71 in Poko and 42 in Viadana; the ultra-cold chain equipment has been received at the PEV antenna in Buta, 99.3% of individual data are encoded in DHIS2 and the focal points have been briefed for the ERVEBO acceptability survey among PPLs.

2.6.2. Challenges

Low uptake of vaccination among people living with HIV and TPL in Tshopo, where coverage has not been updated, and risk of loss of 352 thawed doses expiring on September 24, 2026; in Bas-Uélé, absence of a micro-plan for vaccinating people living with HIV in the 6 priority health zones and need for additional doses of ERVEBO

2.7. Continuity of Care

- In **Tshopo**, 164 cases received the experimental treatment, including 25 confirmed (3 under MBP134 and 22 under Remdesivir: 10 cured, 7 deceased, 1 escaped and 7 in treatment), and 139 are under post-exposure prophylaxis (94 completed, 11 interrupted and 34 in progress).
- In **Bas-Uélé**, the first test to control the confirmed case isolated at the Ganga General Referral Hospital has returned Negative on day 8.

2.8. Risk Communication and Community Engagement (RCCE)

2.8.1. Main actions

- In **Ituri**, 56,433 home visits reached 95,073 people and 1,197 educational talks reached 28,117 people; 54 mass awareness campaigns reached 3,285 people, 41 community debates brought together 437 people and 9 advocacy sessions with 17 people; 295 community alerts were notified, including 48 deaths, 114 feedbacks were received, of which 91 were resolved (79.8%), and 9 community incidents, of which 6 were resolved (66.7%), for a completeness of 35.7% (10/28 ZS); 47 local leaders conducted a guided tour of the Nia-Nia CTE.
- In **North Kivu**, 9,500 home visits reached 28,539 people, and 69 educational talks were held. with 2,627 people reached and 15 mass communication sessions enabled to reach 5,499 people; 79 alerts of suspected cases and deaths were notified by community actors out of 450 expected (17.6%); 11 out of 15 feedbacks were resolved within 48 hours (73.3%); 901 out of 4,750 people were engaged in community actions (19.0%) and 1 out of 6 incidents was resolved (16.7%).
- In **Tshopo**, 201 home visits reached 1,126 people and 2 educational talks were organized for the benefit of 92 people; awareness-raising sessions were held in 46 religious denominations with 18,768 faithful (7,882 men and 10,886 women); 4 radio programs were broadcast; 38 ITs and 600 members of the CACs of the Makiso-Kisangani and Wanie-Rukula health zones were trained and 2 feedbacks as well as 3 refusals were resolved.

2.8.2. Challenges

Persistent community resistance: In **Tshopo**, confirmed cases who escaped from the Ebola Treatment Center (20th and 26th cases, Mangobo Health Zone) remain at home, and 10 contacts of the 20th case refuse follow-up. In Ituri, data reporting is low (completeness: 35.7%; 10/28), there is a lack of numerical data on interventions around cases, and demotivation among stakeholders is linked to unpaid bills.

North Kivu: refusal to register and decontaminate bodies in Lubero (4 incidents, only 1 resolved), refusal to secure a body in Musienene and transfer it to the treatment center in Biena, as well as a rumor about child deaths attributed to the vaccine. In Bas-Uélé: poor reporting from health zones, lack of communication credit, and impassable roads.

2.9. Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS)

2.9.1. Main actions

- In Ituri, 23 of the 38 confirmed cases (60.5%) from the previous day and 90 of the 160 confirmed cases under follow-up (56.3%) benefited from SMSPPS interventions, as well as 31 of the 77 new suspects (40.3%) and 126 of the 161 suspects under follow-up (78.3%); 467 caregivers and 44 PPLs were supported, 14 of the 19 recovered (73.7%) were followed up in the community and 61 results were announced, including 23 positive results; 10 of the 28 health zones are covered and 10 children are being followed up in daycare.
- In North Kivu, 10 people among the confirmed cases of the last 48 hours and 68 confirmed cases under follow-up have benefited from SMSPPS interventions, as well as 217 new suspects and 276 suspects under follow-up; 97 announcements of results including 20 positive, 61 households accompanied and 35 PPL supported, 9 recoveries followed in community and 4 of the 7 ZS that notified are covered (57.1%).
- In Tshopo, 2 confirmed cases, 2 new suspected cases and 11 cases under monitoring at the CTE Météo (8 confirmed and 3 suspected) received psychological support; 84 people were supported, including 78 caregivers and 6 PPLs, and 1 positive result was announced.
- In Haut-Uélé, 4 new confirmed cases and 14 confirmed cases under follow-up benefited from SMSPPS interventions, as well as 3 new suspects and 11 suspects under follow-up; 18 results were announced, including 4 positive ones, 54 caregivers and 44 PPLs were supported, 5 separated children were accompanied in the community and 3 EDS were supported.

2.9.2. Challenges

- In Ituri, low coverage of SMSPPS interventions (10 of the 28 health zones covered); in North Kivu, low coverage around the latest confirmed cases in 9 health zones and absence of nurseries in 10 affected health zones; in Tshopo, need to train the APS of the health zones of Wanie-Rukula and Bafwasende.

2.10. Logistics

2.10.1. Main actions

- Support for the mobility of response teams in all affected provinces; continuation of the construction of the Ebola Treatment Center (ETC) at the Musienene General Referral Hospital in North Kivu and the ETC at Bafwasende in Tshopo and delivery of IPC and PEC inputs to the health zones of Ganga, Poko and Viadana in Bas-Uélé with the support of the WHO.

2.10.2. Security

2.10.3. Main actions

- Continued security monitoring in the affected provinces; in North Kivu, 9 security support missions for PCI and EDS teams (decontamination and burials) were carried out in the sub-coordinations of Beni and Katwa (100%).

2.11. PSEA (Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse)

2.11.1. Main actions

- In Ituri, a training on PSEA was organized in Bunia for 12 researchers from INRB (9 men and 3 women) with the support of IMC, and 385 members of the NGO CEMADEP were sensitized with the support of WHO; the display of messages and the distribution of PSEAH leaflets continue in the health zones of Bunia, Aru, Mongbwalu, Mambasa and Fataki, and 12 organisations took part, under the leadership of UNFPA, in the GBV Working Group meeting on the harmonisation of interventions around CTE.

2.11.2. Challenges

- Still insufficient coverage of PSEA activities, with only 13 of the 36 health zones in Ituri (36.1%) aware of the reporting mechanism; lack of mapping of stakeholders and refusal of some partners to align; insufficient mass awareness materials; lack of computer kits and office supplies for the pillar.

MESSAGES CLES

- Active and persistent community transmission is observed in the provinces of Ituri, North Kivu, Haut-Uélé, Tshopo, and Bas-Uélé. However, a decrease in the number of cases has been observed in Ituri province **(26.1%)** over the past 72 hours (from 46 cases to 34 cases).
- The performance of epidemiological investigations remains satisfactory, with **98.4 %** of suspected cases investigated, although the contact tracing rate fluctuates **(81.4%)** resulting from a decline in completeness in several health zones.
- Strengthening interventions (surveillance, care, IPC, logistics and community engagement) remain essential to quickly interrupt transmission chains: Rapidly increase reception capacities in ETCs/CTs in North Kivu and strengthen cross-border surveillance with South Sudan. **Priorities**
- Strengthen preparedness and response to Ebola Virus Disease-B in the provinces of the River Corridor and surrounding areas.

TIMELINE OF KEY EVENTS

- From April 24 to May 15, 2026, the epidemic progressed from the detection of the first suspected cases to the biological confirmation of the Ebola Bundibugyo virus, leading to the official declaration of the 17th Ebola Virus Disease epidemic in the Democratic Republic of Congo.
- Between May 17 and 18, 2026, national authorities, with the support of partners, strengthened the response by declaring a public health emergency of national and then continental scope, accompanied by the mobilization of funds.



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